ETON Advanced French Grammar: Specialists

EW 20

119. ADVERBS

Formation of adverbs

a) **from adjectives ending in a vowel** : take the masculine form and add *-ment*

vrai + *ment: vraiment* absolu + *ment: absolument*

b) **from most adjectives ending in a consonant** : take feminine form and add *-ment*

heureux → *heureuse* → *heureusement* essentiel → *essentielle* → *essentiellement*

c) **from adjectives ending *-ant*/*-ent*** : remove *-ant/-ent* and add *-amment/-emment*

constant → *const* → *constamment* évident → *évid* → *évidemment*

d) some common exceptions

gai	**gaiement**	*aveugle*	**aveuglément**	*énorme*	**énormément**
gentil	**gentiment**	*commun*	**communément**	*précis*	**précisément**
bref	**brièvement**	*confus*	**confusément**	*profond*	**profondément**

Note also	*bien*	is the adverb	*bon*	is the adjective
	mieux	is the adverb	*meilleur*	is the adjective
	vite or *rapidement* mean "quickly"		*rapide*	is the adjective

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120. Adverbs never agree : they are always INVARIABLE

Note very carefully the spelling of the following adverbs which never change

environ	approximately	**ensemble**	together
tout de suite	at once/immediately	**tout à l'heure**	in a minute/just now

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121. Sometimes adjectives are used as adverbs. In this case they do not agree with the subject of the verb

to be expensive	**coûter cher**	to see clearly	**voir clair**
to talk loudly	**parler fort**	to work hard	**travailler dur**
to talk quietly	**parler bas**	to fall thickly	**tomber dru**
to be heavy	**peser lourd**	(rain, leaves etc.)	
to smell nice	**sentir bon**	to sing out of tune	**chanter faux**
to smell nasty	**sentir mauvais**		

Ils parlaient fort *Elle sent mauvais* *Les feuilles tombaient dru*

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122. Position

a) adverbs NEVER come between a subject and a verb

b) *tout*, *mieux*, *bien*, *beaucoup*, *tant*, *trop*, *tous* all stand

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

- **before an infinitive** : *pour mieux voir; je dois tout faire*

- **before a past participle** : *elle a tout vu; il a bien joué; j'ai trop bu*

c) common short adverbs (*toujours*, *souvent*, *déjà*, *encore*) always stand between the auxiliary and the past participle

J'ai toujours pensé que .....; je leur ai souvent dit que . . .

d) Note the fixed order of the following negatives + adverbs:

not yet	**ne . . .pas encore**	*elle n'est pas encore arrivée*
not even	**ne . . .même pas**	*je ne les ai même pas vu(e)s*
still not	**ne . . .toujours pas**	*ils ne les ont toujours pas lu(e)s*

e) emphatic adverbs of time often stand at the beginning of a phrase : *soudain il l'a vu devant lui*

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123. Always be alert to the possibility that English ". . . .ly" adverbs might best be rendered by an adverbial phrase introduced by de. The possibilities are:

- speech **d'une voix . . .** / **d'un ton . . .** _ look/expression **d'un air . . .**
- gait **d'un pas . . .** _ manner **d'une manière/ d'une façon**

Il a parlé d'un ton bizarre *Elle a marché d'un pas vif*

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124. <u>Some important points</u>

- even more + adverb : **encore plus + adverb** (NEVER *même plus*)

- <u>in</u> a ----- way : **<u>d</u>'une façon / <u>d</u>'une manière . . .**

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125. <u>faire + INFINITIVE</u>

When one verb is followed by another, the second verb is ALWAYS an INFINITIVE.

Note the word order:

faire + INFINITIVE + NOUN	*Je ferai peindre la maison*
PRONOUN + *faire* + INFINITIVE	*Je la ferai peindre*

a) To convey the idea of "having something done" or "getting something done"

I had the car repaired	*J'ai fait réparer la voiture*
I will get this letter signed	*Je ferai signer cette lettre*

N.B. There is no PDO agreement on the past participle of *faire* when it is used in this way.

(The car) I have had it repaired	*(La voiture) Je l'ai fai<u>t</u> réparer*

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If the subject of the verb is getting something done to himself, herself or themselves *faire* becomes reflexive. Note that there is no agreement of the past participle, just as in (a) above

She had her hair cut	*Elle s'est fait couper les cheveux*

b) To convey the idea of "making someone do" something:

1. When the following infinitive DOES NOT HAVE a direct object or a dependent *que* clause, *faire* takes a direct object (pronouns: *me*, *te*, *le*, *la*, *nous*, *vous*, *les*)

I made her forget	*Je l'ai fait oublier* (no agreement)
I made my mother sing	*J'ai fait chanter ma mère*

2. When the following infinitive DOES HAVE a direct object or a dependent *que* clause, *faire* takes an indirect construction (pronouns *me, te lui*, *nous*, *vous*, *leur*)

I made her forget her worries	*Je **lui** ai fait oublier ses soucis*
I made her forget she had any worries	*Je **lui** ai fait oublier qu'elle avait des soucis*
I made my mother sing a song	*J'ai fait chanter une chanson à ma mère*

c) "To make oneself" + PAST PARTICIPLE

se faire + INFINITIVE

They made themselves heard	*Ils se sont fait entendre*
She made herself obeyed	*Elle s'est fait obéir*
We made ourselves understood	*Nous nous sommes fait comprendre*

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